

PUBLIC EXAMPLE

Enactment Sheet

How a commercial review becomes something people can actually use

What this is

Most reviews fail in the gap between “we should do this” and somebody actually doing it. This is the sheet that closes that gap. For each change it says what the rule is, where it lives, who checks it and what evidence proves it has happened.

What was happening in the business

The client was an owner-run service business with capable people, strong relationships and real opportunities. The issue was not a lack of effort. The business had grown faster than some of the controls around it.

Too much could still be started, changed or redirected without a clear record of what had been agreed. Too much relied on the owner remembering, deciding and following through. There were also cash items that needed checking, CRM defects and costs to sort out, unclear ownership of live leads, thousands of old records and weak visibility from activity through to cash.

What the review found

Owner dependence Decisions and priorities relied too heavily on one person.	Money and systems Cash questions, CRM costs and system defects needed proper reconciliation.
Projects New work could begin without enough control over cost, priority or displaced work.	Leads and data Live leads needed clear ownership and old records needed a sensible clean-up method.
Commercial visibility The business needed one view from activity through to cash and net retained value.	Continuity Key knowledge, access and decision authority needed to work even when the owner was unavailable.

What happened next

The review became an 11-point action plan. This Enactment Sheet is the shorter operating layer underneath it: the part that makes the actions repeatable and checkable rather than leaving them as recommendations in a report.

THE WORKING RULES

Control and delivery

The point is not just to decide what should change. It is to make the change visible, owned and checkable.

1. Decision rights

Name one operational lead. The owner keeps strategic direction, major opportunities and key relationships. If an agreed delivery priority changes, record the reason, impact and displaced work before the plan changes.

RECORDED IN

Authority statement and 12-month plan.

CHECKED BY

Business owner and operational lead monthly, and whenever a major priority changes.

EVIDENCE

A named role, protected time, clear decision boundaries and fewer conflicting instructions.

2. Weekly operating rhythm

Use one fixed weekly agenda and one live action register. Every open action carries an owner, deadline, status, next step, help needed and completion evidence.

RECORDED IN

Meeting agenda and live action register.

CHECKED BY

Operational lead weekly.

EVIDENCE

Actions carry correctly from meeting to meeting and overdue work stays visible.

3. Cash and CRM checks

Reconcile unresolved income exposures and current CRM costs against source records. Treat uncertain amounts as exposures until the evidence is checked.

RECORDED IN

Commercial exceptions register with source references.

CHECKED BY

Finance owner and operational lead until every item is closed.

EVIDENCE

Each item is reconciled or has a dated recovery or correction action.

4. Direction and priorities

Agree the three-year direction and practical 12-month priorities. Record what the business is not prioritising as well as what it is.

RECORDED IN

Approved commercial plan and decision-rights record.

CHECKED BY

Business owner quarterly; operational lead monthly.

EVIDENCE

New work can be traced to an agreed priority and has a clear owner and measure.

THE WORKING RULES

Projects, systems and customers

These controls stop important work becoming dependent on memory, informal conversations or one person carrying everything.

5. Project control

Run one main discretionary strategic project at a time. Other ideas go to a visible backlog. Every proposal states purpose, full cost, expected result, owner, deadline and the work it will replace or delay.

RECORDED IN

Project and decision register, backlog and relevant decision record.

CHECKED BY

Operational lead weekly; business owner at decision points.

EVIDENCE

The active project and parked alternatives are visible, with decisions recorded before work starts.

6. CRM ownership

Name one CRM owner and one deputy. Defects close only after correction evidence and representative user testing. Train staff using real business examples.

RECORDED IN

CRM process, defect register, staff guide and training record.

CHECKED BY

CRM owner weekly until accepted, then monthly.

EVIDENCE

Defects are tested, staff use one agreed process and the full CRM cost is understood.

7. Live leads and old data

Give every live lead one owner, one visible next action and a due date. Do not manually inspect thousands of old records. Classify them by meaningful events, deduplicate them and sample the results for accuracy.

RECORDED IN

CRM, legacy classification file and exception register.

CHECKED BY

CRM owner weekly; sample-quality review before acceptance.

EVIDENCE

No live lead lacks an owner or next action, and the error rate in the old data is known.

8. Monthly commercial close

Follow converted clients from activity through expected and recurring income, invoice, receipt, payout and net retained value. Keep incomplete items open with an owner and review date.

RECORDED IN

Commercial management view supported by the CRM, accounting system and business bank.

CHECKED BY

Commercial or finance owner monthly.

EVIDENCE

A monthly close is completed, recurring income is reviewed and exceptions remain visibly owned.

THE WORKING RULES

Money, protection and performance

The last part makes sure commercial decisions can be traced, checked and carried on safely by more than one person.

9. Partner review

Rank commercial partners by actual activity, terms, cash and credible potential, not simply because they appear on a list. Test a small number of dormant agreements that are genuinely worth reopening.

RECORDED IN

Partner commercial review and action list.

CHECKED BY

Commercial owner monthly.

EVIDENCE

Priority partners are reviewed, missing terms are owned and clear next actions exist.

10. Continuity and access

Record key commitments and decision authority. Move passwords to a proper manager, use named access and two-factor authentication, remove obsolete permissions and separate personal financial information from business management records.

RECORDED IN

Continuity file, password manager, access register and system settings.

CHECKED BY

Operational lead monthly and after staff or supplier changes.

EVIDENCE

Another authorised person can find the information and access needed to keep the business moving safely.

11. Performance and incentives

Do not introduce a paid bonus until definitions, attribution and net contribution are reliable. Test more than one shadow model and check what behaviour each would encourage.

RECORDED IN

Baseline report and shadow-bonus review.

CHECKED BY

Business owner and operational lead at the 90-day review.

EVIDENCE

A reliable baseline exists, shadow calculations are complete and there is a recorded decision on whether to proceed.

Why this matters

A commercial review should not end with a list of recommendations. The useful bit is turning those recommendations into something people can actually follow, check and keep using after the review is finished.

If parts of this feel familiar in your business, that is what the Arrington Commercial Review is designed to uncover.

This is an anonymised public example based on a real client review. Names, organisations, locations, dates, figures and other identifying details have been removed or generalised. It shows the controls recommended; it does not claim that every recommendation was subsequently implemented.